

Chairs Welcome and apologies from Cllr Margaret Kennedy and David Beveridge

The AGM covered financial standing, road safety progress, and ongoing community issues. Key achievements include securing two speed platforms near Ceres Primary School and one in Craigrothie. Persistent concerns remain around ineffective traffic calming at Ceres village pedestrian crossing, poor mobile connectivity, and a proposed raised crossing linked to the Baltilly housing development.

- Jeremy Baker felt the **Speed platform at pedestrian crossing** for Ceres School deemed ineffective; outbound platform near Craigrothie confirmed as the better model.
- **Defibrillator replacement** on Cooper Road approved and paid (£1,490); servicing of two others (Village Shop, Craigrothie Village Hall) also covered.
- **AGM date moved** from July to **10 May 2027** to avoid holiday period.
- **Community councillors** confirmed on 4-year terms until **2028**; elections now managed by Fife Council, not at AGM.
- **Grant spending rules** under review; current annual grant is **£589.12** — strategy discussed to route funds via councillor expenses then donate back if restrictions tighten.

Road Safety & Planning

- Two speed platforms secured at Ceres Primary School following a crossing patrol officer being struck by a car.
- **Baltilly development:** Council internal dispute over affordable housing (on-site vs. cash contribution to Kennoway) appears resolved; development expected to start soon, with car park for Ceres Highland Games unavailable by 2027.
- **Raised crossing at Loch garage entrance:** Councillor John Caffrey pressing developer to fund a speed table; Fife Council currently states no raised platform needed due to 20 mph zone — disputed strongly.
- **Former Loch garage site:** Planning application submitted, neighbour consultation closed; new building planned for small animal care by owners who are local to the area.
- **Bus stop yellow box lines** newly painted in Craigrothie;
Police speed camera presence noted on Weymsshall Road.

Connectivity

- Mobile coverage (O2/Sky) degraded due to network overload; Vodafone investment cited as a potential solution but **no confirmed timeline** (year 2030 mentioned).
- **Impact on emergency services:** Nurses unable to transmit ECGs; forced to discuss confidential patient information outdoors to find signal.
- **Ceres Games:** £1,850 spent on Starlink to provide trader connectivity due to zero local coverage — raised as an economic argument for lobbying.
- Land offered locally for mast installation; MPs/MSPs (Wendy Chamberlain, Willie) engaged but progress slow.

Pending Confirmation

- Whether grant funds can be spent on community purposes (e.g., senior citizens, defibrillator servicing) beyond administrative expenses — John Caffrey to re-clarify with Fife Council.
- Developer funding for raised speed table at Baltilly and Loch garage entrance — John Caffrey working on this; Chris Smith email disputes prior agreement.
- 20 mph zone signage gaps (e.g., Cupar Road junction) — legal status of unsigned sections under street lighting debated, unresolved.
- Bus timetable: Route 46 missing from one side of bus stop in Craigrothie — to be raised with Stagecoach/Council transport department.

Open Questions

- **Who is responsible for the deteriorating wall/drainage structure near old works on Old Bill Road?**
- Could the vet practice (new development) contribute to cost of speed table given traffic impact?
- Roundabout at village entrance: raised as ideal given new development traffic, but noted as unlikely given approved road plans.

Action Items

- **John Caffrey:** Re-clarify grant spending rules with Fife Council and report back.
- **John Caffrey:** Continue lobbying developer for speed table funding; counter Chris Smith's email.
- Alistair/Neil continue to Lobby Wendy Chamberlain and Willie on Vodafone connectivity investment; share Starlink cost data from Games.

- **Community member:** Raise Route 46 timetable omission with Stagecoach or Council transport.
- **Community:** Submit improved written description of Ceres for Local Tourism Association (current online description described as "awful").
- **Ceres Trust:** Host public meeting at new bridge (within ~2 weeks) to discuss Glebe development and Peace Garden design.
- **Next meeting: 14 September 2026**, Craigrothie Village Hall.